

CHABAD OF PARKLAND

רֵאָה אֲנִי נֹתֵן לְפָנֶיכֶם הַיּוֹם בְּרָכָה

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Maamor — free translation & elucidation · Shabbos Parshas Re'eh, Elul 5748 · bilti-mugah

⌘ MAAMOR

Alter Rebbe: Rabbi Shneur Zalman of Liadi, founder and first Rebbe of Chabad, 1745-1813. Author of Shulchan Oruch HoRav, and the Tanya. Delivered Maamorim that were then published in Likkutei Torah, Torah Or and Maamorei Admur Hazoken.

Chassidishe Parsha: This week's Parsha: The section of Likkutei Torah and Torah Or on the weekly Parsha is referred to as the Chasidishe Parsha. As the Rebbe says: "Everyone should take upon themselves, without a vow, to finish

The Parsha starts off with the words of the Possuk: “

Behold I: Hakodosh Boruch Hu.

Set Before you: The B'nei Yisroel.

רֵאָה אֲנִי כִּי נֹתֵן לְפָנֶיכֶם הַיּוֹם בְּרָכָה וְקָלָה

Behold, I set before you today a blessing ...”.

This week's Parsha: Parshas Re'ay.

CONCEPT

Of the Possuk: (Devorim 26:11) רֵאָה אֲנִי כִּי נֹתֵן לְפָנֶיכֶם הַיּוֹם בְּרָכָה וְקָלָה לְכָל לֵה “Behold, I set before you today a blessing and a curse” Rashi says: “Those that were stated, respectively, on Mount Gerizim and on Mount Eival”.

. The Alter Rebbe explains in this week's Chassidishe Parsha of Likkutei Torah, highlighting the words of this the two Seforim of Likkutei Torah and Torah Or (not including the section dealing with Shir HaShirim) until the week of Shabbos Parshas Bereshis, then we will start to read the Torah again from the beginning. Everyone should learn the Maamarim for the Parsha of the week.”

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Likkutei Torah: The work was published originally in two parts. The first part, Torah Or, was first printed in 5597 (1837) in Kopust, with Maamorim delivered by the Alter Rebbe, and transcribed by the Alter Rebbe's brother amongst others, most of them from 5556 (1796) through the end of 5572 (1812), covering the books of Bereishis and Shmos, with several Maamorim on Shavuot and Pesach. The second half was published in Zhitomir in 5608 (1848) under the title Likkutei

Possuk ,

רִאָאָה אֲנִי כִי־נִתַּן

and says this refers to אֲנִי כִי מִי שֶׁ אֲנִי כִי "I am who I am"

○

נִתַּן לְפָנֶיכֶם

... give you blessings to your נִתַּן Right into your inner core.

CONCEPT

Right into your inner core: The word נִתַּן has the word נִתַּן inside it which normally means 'face' hence the meaning of 'נִתַּן before you' however the word נִתַּן also means 'internal' from the word 'נִתַּן right into your inner core hence'.

Blessings are a state of 'vision' as they are visible and recognisable. (This differs from 'admission' יב which is based on belief as opposed to blessing which is akin to vision). This explains ,

Blessings are: A revealed and discernible light in this world adding the ability to see.
 נ'Recognisable: And therefore, the Torah uses an expression that means to see when discussing blessings. ב'Admission: when a person admits and agrees without fully understanding the situation.

Torah, with Maamorim covering the books of Vayikra, Bamidbar and Devorim, Shir Hashirim, Yomim Tovim, Rosh Hashana & Yom Kipur. I am who I am: Hakodosh Boruch Hu Himself spiritually higher than any name, which means higher than any Divine level that is known by name. the Possuk (Zecharia 14:9) states :

וְהָיָה יְהוָה לְמֶלֶךְ עַל-כָּל-הָאָרֶץ בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא. יְהוָה ה' אֶחָד וְשִׁמוֹ אֶחָד

“HaShem shall become King over all the earth; on that day shall HaShem be one, and His name one.”

When Moshiach comes HaShem’s holy name will be one with His Shechina, until that time it is our Avodah to cause that unity through our deeds.

‘HaShem setting inside us blessing’ ו'from a supernal level of ‘Onochi’ we are able to ׳reach a level of ״ vision, which is symbolic of ‘Bittul’ – self nullification ׳at the lofty level of ‘Supernal Chochma’. ׳Here we need clarification! This is because the Alter Rebbe explains in Likkutei Torah in (the Chassidishe Parsha of) Parshas Vo’eschanan, that when Moshe׳ ו'Inside us blessing: With the power of the blessings the B’nei Yisroel merited to attain a level of ‘vision’. ׳We are able to: With the power of this Brocha, we merit to reach a level of ‘vision’. ׳Self-nullification: The more a person is in touch and engrossed with his physicality and material surroundings the more clouded and obscured is his sensitivity to spirituality and his ability to hear and see G-dliness around him. Conversely, the more one selfnullifies his ego and puts his personal needs and wants aside, and the less a person is immersed in his material life and well being the more clarity he will have in his spiritual vision and the higher sensitivity to HaShem’s touch on his very soul. ׳Supernal Chochma: A Bittul (selfnullification) to HaShem from the highest level of Chochmah. The word Chochma contains the words ‘Koach-Mah’ the power of ‘Mah’ (The power of ‘What’) as Moshe and Ahron said ‘Venachnu Mah’ but ‘What’ are we? Which symbolises complete Bittul and selfnullification. ׳When Moshe requested from HaShem: In his prayers to be allowed entry in to Eretz Yisroel. In the Possuk (Devorim 3:25) ׀

אֶעֱבֹרָהּ נָא וְאַרְאֶהָ אֶת-הָאָרֶץ הַטּוֹבָה אֲשֶׁר בְּעֵבְרָהּ יְרֵדוּן ״ הָהָר הַטּוֹב הַזֶּה׀

Pray let me cross

requested of HaShem ׀

אֵעָבְרָהּ נֹא וְאֶרְאֶה אֶת־הָאָרֶץ הַטּוֹבָה הַזֹּאת

“Let me cross over and see the good land”, what Moshe was really requesting, was to draw down into ‘Kenesses Yisroel’

’וּa state of ‘Re’iyah’, – a state of ‘vision’ an ability for all Yisroel to see. However, Moshe nevertheless was not able to achieve (practically) this mammoth task of drawing down the ability for all of Yisroel to have a ‘visual’ connection with HaShem, and [so] instead he drew down an ability for ‘Kenesses Yisroel’ to connect to HaShem through ‘listening’. כֹּא over and see the good land that is on the other side of the river Yarden, this good mountain and the Lebanon.” יח What Moshe Was really requesting: With the words of his statement .

אֵעָבְרָהּ נֹא וְאֶרְאֶה

Pray let me cross over and see.

י Kenesses Yisroel: The Jewish people collectively, a name that refers to the body of souls of the Jewish people at source, before any descent into this world. To see: That all Neshomos of Yisroel would merit through their Bittul to visually appreciate Gdlines, to have a visual connection with HaShem. To be able to connect to HaShem though vision. כֹּא Through listening: Which is technically a spiritually lower connection to HaShem than a connection of vision.

This can be seen כב when Moshe says thereafter: .

וַעֲתָה כֹּה יִשְׁרָאֵל

וְעַתָּה כֹּה יִשְׁרָאֵל And now Yisroel listen”

‘Listen’ being the operative word. כד It can be said that this is also what the Possuk writes כה in Parshas Eikev (The Parsha after Vo’eschanan): .

וְהָיָה “עֲקֵבִית

וְהָיָה “עֲקֵבִית And it will be, because you will listen” כו ‘Listen’

again being the operative word. [This is also] because Moshe Rabeinu was unable to draw down into the B'nei Yisroel the ability to connect to HaShem through [the level of] 'vision', but only the ability to כב This can be seen: In the words of the Possuk (Devorim 4:1) ;

וְעַתָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל שְׁמַעְ אֶל־הַחֻקִּים וְאֶל־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים אֲשֶׁר אֲנִי כֹמֵד לְמַדְּאֲתָם
כִּם לַעֲשׂוֹת לְמַעַן תְּחִיּוּ בְּאֶתְמֹ וִיִּרְשׁוּ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר הִ' אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתֵיכֶם
נִתֵּן

“:לְכָם And now, O Israel, listen to the statutes and to the judgments which I teach you to do, in order that you may live, and go in and possess the land which HaShem, Gd of your forefathers, is giving you.”

כב Thereafter: In the continuation in the Pessukim, after as King HaShem .

אֵעָבֹב רַחֲמֵי נְאֻם אֱלֹהֵי אֲרָאָה

which was unsuccessful.

כד Operative word: The inference is on the word 'Listen'. כה The Possuk writes: (Devorim 7:12) ;

וְהָיָה עָקֵב תִּשְׁמָעוּן אֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִים הָאֵלֶּה וְשִׁמְרֵתֶם וַעֲשִׂיתֶם אֲתָם וְיָשַׁר
מִרְאֵי קִיָּר לְךָ אֶת־הַבְּרִית הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע

“:לְכָם And it will be, because you will listen to these ordinances and keep them and perform, that HaShem, your G-d, will keep for you the covenant and the kindness that He swore to your forefathers.”

“כז You will listen”: Also over here, in our case, the Torah was specific and chose to use the word “שָׁמַעְתֶּם” “You will listen”, connoting a terminology of “hearing” and “listening”.

כז Accordingly, כח the Possuk in our Parsha , connect through [the level of] 'listening'.

רִאֵא אֲנִי כִּי־נִתֵּן לִפְנֵיכֶם הַיּוֹם גִּוֹ

seems difficult to understand.

Especially when the Alter Rebbe explains in Likkutei Torah our Possuk to mean “Drawing down the ability to connect to Connect through listening: Because a connection through “listening” is on a much lower level than a connection through seeing. For there is a well-known aphorism: “You can’t compare hearing to (the higher level of) seeing.” Simply speaking, when someone hears anything on the grape vine, a rumour, a story etc, they may have doubts regarding the details and the validity of what they hear. However, when a person sees something occur, with his physical eyes, immediately all doubts are erased, and the truth is set in his mind and confirmed as fact! So too with our relationship to HaShem, we can experience G-dliness in a “hearing” manner, with doubts and disbeliefs or sometimes on a higher plane, were we metaphorically “see” G-dliness, with no concerns and have full trust! Accordingly: Considering that we have just established that in Parshas Vo’eschanon (two weeks ago) Moshe attempted to draw down into the B’nei Yisroel the ability to connect to HaShem through seeing but was unable to as the Possuk then confirms that Moshe then settled for the next best thing which is connect to HaShem through the channel of listening. Difficult to understand: When in this week’s Parsha [the Alter Rebbe explains that] Moshe says that he did achieve the ability to connect to HaShem through vision.

HaShem through the faculty of ‘vision’”. This would imply that every single Jew not only has the ability to connect to and serve HaShem through his ‘auditory’ faculty but also through the faculty of ‘vision’ “לא.ה.א. An explanation however can be given [which] accords with that which is stated in Likkutei Torah; [namely] that this Hamshocha לב that connects on a state of ‘vision’ comes from the [lofty Divine] level of א.נ.כ.י.מ.י.ש.א.נ.כ.י. This Faculty of vision: The Alter Rebbe explains that Moshe drew down the ability for every Jew to connect to HaShem not only through our hearing sense but also in our seeing power, for every Jew, innately possesses the capability to work hard and gain closeness to G-dliness through “hearing” and seeing! Vision: However, this implies that Moshe wanted to draw down our natural level of “sight” in G-dliness, however, practically speaking, Moshe only drew down our level of “hearing” HaShem (?)... This poses a difficulty which will now be further explored. This Hamshocha: The impetus and stimulus to be able to connect to HaShem with this kind of visual clarity. Lofty Divine level: Of HaShem beyond the [lower] level of Divine names.

means that this ‘Hamshocha’ from a state of ‘vision’ is only possible from the lofty level of

לד.א.נ.כ.י.מ.י

א.נ.כ.י.מ.י.ש.א.נ.כ.י where no letter or even sign can even hint at this Divine level.לה. Accordingly, it can be said, that where in Likkutei Torah in Parshas Vo’eschanan it explains that Moshe was unable to

effectuate this connection (of ‘vision’), it א.נ.כ.י.מ.י.ש.א.נ.כ.י: i.e HaShem’s very essence and being. Divine level: Regarding this level of HaShem as He is in His most simple form,

with no attachments or involvement with any alien force, the Zohar comments that this level is higher than any level or hinting of a certain letter or even the miniscule “crowns” on top of the letters. The letters themselves oft have a connection to HaShem’s attributes and creative power, however in our case, this supreme level, superior to any other term used to refer to HaShem, isn’t even able to be ascribed to the minor, dashes, little “crowns” on top of, and secondary to the letter. Rather, there isn’t even a specific expression or a “nickname” that can be used for this level of HaShem because it’s a level of HaShem which is higher than possible investment in the letters as is explained there in Likkutei Torah: “The explanation is, that one cannot recognise nor comprehend this level of ‘I’ besides for the I, Himself... Which is a level of His essence and being as it isn’t in the realm of grasp or intellectual comprehension at all!” In Chassidus it is explained that the function of a name is primarily for the benefit of a second person to refer to and to call the bearer of the name. At this lofty Divine level of Gdliness there is no scope or reason for a name. ¹⁷Connection: Within the Jewish people.

refers to a ‘Hamshocha’ ¹⁷through the regular system of ‘Seder Hishtalshelus’ ¹⁷which are all lower levels than that of ‘Onochi’ because they have limitations. ¹⁷ ¹⁷Hamshocha: Lit. an extension of spiritual energy or Divine power in revelation from above to below. In our case we’re talking about a drawing down and a revelation of G-dliness upon the Jewish people, us. ¹⁷Seder Hishtalshelus: Lit. the evolution/chain reaction of the spiritual cosmos. The order of descent and contraction of Hashem’s infinite divine light and creative power by way of a chain where each level in this chain is connected to the level above as well as the level below like a link in a chain as the infinite Divine light filters through levels and worlds in a gradual orderly fashion from the infinite supernal divine light above contracting and descending down from one level to the next level through the ten supernal Sefiros in each of the four groups of spiritual worlds from the highest link being Chochma of Atzilus and the lowest level being Malchus of Asiyah thus transforming the light from an allpowerful infinite light that is far too intense for any living being to experience down to a contracted light that can then create and bring our finite world and its inhabitants into existence and continue to vitalise all the worlds and all that they contain. In our case we’re talking about a G-dly light, passing through this gradual process and descending from the metaphysical abode of unfiltered divinity and coming down below here, assuming a physical form in a gradual, structured manner, in a measured and limited way. ¹⁷Limitations: All this revelation takes place in the limited, level-by-level set up of “Seder Hishtalshelus” (see previous footnote). So perhaps it could be answered that because the Divine light and power that comes through the Seder Hishtalshelus is so contracted Moshe was therefore unable [in Parshas Vo’eschanon] to draw through it the impetus to connect on such a lofty level that is associated with the clarity of vision, whereas here [in Parshas Re’ay] we refer to HaShem’s unfiltered light ¹⁰ | P a g e

Therefore, at best, Moshe was only able to affect a connection through an Avodah of ‘listening’ between the B’nei Yisroel and Hakodosh Boruch Hu, but not a deeper connection through the Avodah of ‘seeing’. Whereas, in this week’s Parsha ¹⁸in Likkutei Torah, when the Alter Rebbe says that everybody has access to a connection through the Avodah of ‘seeing’ [this is so] because this Hamshocha ¹⁸of ‘seeing’ is given to us directly from the lofty

supernal level of ‘Onochi’ (אֲנִי – כִּי – הָיָה) (I give). This is so because when the Hamshocha comes from the and energy that comes direct from HaShem’s very essence without being contracted through the Seder Hishtalshelus and therefore due to this special direct connection there perhaps can be a connection associated with vision after all. Avodah of seeing: Perhaps Moshe wanted to make our connection to HaShem easier, stronger and more secure, HaShem on the other hand wants us to work the Birur deeper. If Moshe would have taken us into Eretz Yisroel we would never have stooped so low. HaShem wants us to delve into to the lowest spaces of this world and bring His light there. Perhaps if Moshe would have been successful it would have lifted us up and not allowed us to get involved on the lower side of the world.

Parsha: Re’eh Hamshocha: And revelation. 11 | Page

Divine level of

מִגִּדְּאֵי כִּי מִי

אֲנִי כִּי there are no limitations so that every single Jew has the [unlimited] potential to attain this lofty level of ‘vision’

in G-dliness. [This becomes] particularly so, according to the [interpretation of the] specific phraseology used by the Possuk; the word אֲנִי which implies that there is a novel ‘gifting’ of this unique Hamshocha. The manner in which it is given is in accordance with the dictum אֲנִי כִּי מִגִּדְּאֵי: I.e.: HaShem’s Essence. The ultimate in spirituality.

Limitations: Thus, also when there is eventually a revelation of this level, then the revelation will also be in an infinite, unbound manner. ‘Vision’ in G-dliness: And not only in the nether level of ‘hearing’ in G-dliness. אֲנִי: This phrase is in the present Hebrew form, meaning, “I give (constantly, currently etc)”. the Torah was specific in its choice of language and chose to write this phrase in the present unlike the Torah’s common practise of speaking in the past form like in a story circumstance where the natural way of speaking for the Torah, would deem our phrase to be referring to something given, in the past. A new unique gifting: Of something which was otherwise unavailable previously. The dictum: Talmud (Bava Basra 53a) “Rav raises a dilemma: How does one acquire a gift, i.e., is it necessary for the giver to say: Go, take possession and thereby 12 | Page

“One who gives a gift gives it generously” so most certainly with regards to this lofty level there are no boundaries; and [thus] the potential to connect to HaShem through ‘vision’ is extended into Yisroel. With this explanation, we can now understand that which the Possuk writes: –

אֲנִי כִּי אֶתֵּן לְפָנֶיךָ הַיּוֹם בְּרָכָה וּבְלָאָה

“I set before you today a blessing and a curse”.

For acquire? Shmuel said: What dilemma is raised to Abba, i.e., Rav? Now one could say the following: And what is the Halacha with regards to a sale, where the buyer is giving money to the seller? If the seller says to the buyer: Go, take possession and thereby acquire the property, the acquisition does take effect, but if he did not say this, it does not. Therefore, with regards to a gift, where no money is given to the seller, is it not all the more so reasonable that the acquisition not take effect without a clear directive from the seller? The Gemara answers: And Rav holds _

מאן דתני להיב מתנה ב: עין פה י היב

that ‘one who gives a gift gives it generously’

and would allow the acquisition even absent a clear directive. **ו**Generously: So too, with our topic of discussion, certainly the Divine “giving”, meaning the revelation of “I, who gives” {HaShem} will be in a way of “With a generous eye” {In a way one would give a present, generously}. No Boundaries: Therefore, to say that the revelation of our ability to “hear” G-dliness will be the first and seemingly only revelation is nonsensical. Since such a lofty level is going to be tapped into, the Hamshocha and revelation will progress and eventually lead into that of a higher, unlimited level of “seeing” HaShem; when dealing with the unlimited, why limit the connection at “seeing” when ultimately one can also attain ‘hearing’? **נא** With this explanation: With the availability of a lofty connection to G-dliness, where nothing is impossible because there are no boundaries. 13 | Page

seemingly, according to that which has been explained above, **נב** what relevance does a curse have **נג** here amongst such a lofty and positive topic of discussion? The answer is **נד** that the concept behind this curse **נה** is the ability to transform the curse into a blessing, just as **נו** Above: According to that which we explained above that, when speaking about a giving process, which we now know means a revelation and facilitation, in our case of “seeing” G-dliness, is an extremely sublime matter. **נז** What relevance does a curse have: If what we are discussing is that ‘blessing’ is the impetus to connect with Hashem on a lofty supernal level where all is as clear as vision, what can a curse mean and what relevance does it have to us in this context? **נח** The answer is: That the curse also relates to the same lofty level. **נה** Curse: This curse that we are talking about in the Possuk has transformative powers. Not only are we given a Blessing simply speaking, but we are also given, together with the Blessing, the capability to transform the curse into a blessing! **ני** Just as: The Talmud states (Yuma 86B) Reish Lakish said: Great is Teshuvah (repentance), as the penitent’s intentional sins are counted for him as unwitting transgressions, as it is stated: “Return, Yisroel, to HaShem your Gd, for you have stumbled in your iniquity” (Hoshea 14:2). The Gemara analyzes this: Doesn’t “iniquity” mean an intentional sin? Yet the prophet calls it stumbling, implying that one who repents is considered as though he only stumbled accidentally in his transgression. The Gemara asks: Is that so? Didn’t Reish Lakish himself say:

Great is Teshuvah, as one's intentional sins are counted for him as merits, as it is stated: "And when the wicked turns from his wickedness, and does that which is lawful and right, he shall live thereby"

(Yechezkal 33:19)? The Gemara reconciles: This is not difficult: Here, when one repents out of love, his sins become like 14 | Page

one can transform transgressions into merits. That the 'Koach' for this Avodah originates also from the lofty Divine level of **כִּי מִי שֶׁאָנֹכִי** that it is Hakodosh Boruch Hu Himself that 'gives generously' 'the ability to transform transgressions into merits'. merits; there, when one repents out of fear, his sins are counted as unwitting transgressions.

Transgressions: Transgressing prohibitive commandments, even when they were committed on purpose which is more severe than when they were committed accidentally. The Koach for this Avoda: The impetus for this service of transforming a "Curse" into a "Blessing" in comparison to transforming a "Transgression" into a "Merit" as discussed in Tractate Yuma 86 B. Transgressions into merits: We know from the Zohar that the Torah precedes the world by two thousand years. Which in an environment beyond time simply means that the Torah stems from a spiritual plane far higher than any of the spiritual or material worlds. In the Torah someone who commits a sin is punishable by one of the Biblically listed penalties. When someone does 'Teshuvah' however he is invoking a power that far transcends the Torah, because the Torah states the penalty for the transgression whereas 'Teshuvah' waives the penalty together with the transgression and if 'Teshuvah' is sincere out of love for Hashem it can even transform his committed transgressions into merits. The impetus for this can only come from a Divine spiritual level that is far beyond the Torah which automatically means beyond the worlds. Here the Rebbe shows us that it comes from the same place spiritually as the ability to transform a curse into a blessing which is the same place spiritually that allows us to connect with Hashem in a 'visual' capacity. 15 | Page

In other words, besides that which the Alter Rebbe explains in Likkutei Torah on Parshas Bechukosai that the curses are exalted revelations of blessings that can only be revealed in this style, the Alter Rebbe brings down an [illustrative] incident from the Talmud in Moed Koton [showing] how several statements that Bechukosai: In Parshas Bechukosai, The Torah discusses the curses which are retouched upon here in our Parsha. Blessings: These curses are higher than the Blessings which are revealed and expressed in an explicit, worldly form. In Chassidus it is discussed how sometimes when the goodness that Hashem shows us is so very pure, when it filters down into our world of lies and concealments it is expressed in unwelcomed manner due to the influence of the negative forces which are in this lowly world. Style: As is explained in Likkutei Torah that according to the truth being Hashem's greater plan, these curses we mention are really only Blessings {In disguise}. Brings down: In Likkutei Torah. Moed Koton: (9B). There is a story in the Gemorah

where Rabbi Shimon Bar Yochai sends his son Reb Elozer to get a Brocha from the Chachomim (Sages) and they said to his son: “May it be HaShem’s will that you should plant and not harvest, you should enter and not exit, you should exit and not enter, He will destroy your house, and your guests will sit in it, He will confuse your table and you won’t see a new year”. And it appears from this ambiguous exchange that the sages didn’t only not bless him but rather they pained and cursed him! And when Reb Elozer told his father about what happened, Reb Shimon told him that in fact all these are actually blessings. How so? “You should plant and not harvest”-‘You should give birth and your children shouldn’t die’, “You should enter and not exit”-‘You shall herald in brides for your sons and they won’t

initially seemed to be the opposite of blessings were each in turn explained as beautiful blessings for a revealed good, besides all that, there is [now introduced the novel concept of] a ‘Koach’ to transform a curse into a blessing. All of the above can now be connected with the ‘die nor divorce’, “You shall exit and not enter”-‘You should give birth (exiting the womb) and your children shouldn’t die (enter the world to come)’, “He will destroy your house and guests will settle there”-‘This world is your guest and the world to come is your house’, “He will confuse your table”-‘Your children’, “And you will not see a new month”-‘Your wife won’t die and you won’t have to remarry’. The above Talmudic story from Moed Kotton demonstrates the concept of a blessing disguised as a curse. Transform a curse into a blessing: Perhaps it can be said that whilst the curse is immersed in this lowly world it appears to be a curse because in comparison to its negative surroundings it is a curse, but when explained as in the story in the Talmud in a beautiful way then these curses are elevated slightly to allow for their innate blessing to shine through. However there still needs to be a deeper way to transform these curses into blessings whilst they remain in their own surroundings but for that we will need an extra impetus a greater power from a higher source. The Avodah: The unique service of HaShem that takes place in the month of Elul is in the manner of “I am to my beloved and only then is my beloved is to me”. Elul is a time to seriously audit one’s spiritual accounts and assess the year gone by; a time to prepare for the “Days of Awe” of Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur by repenting the failings of the past and resolving for the future; a time to increase in Torah study, prayer and charitable activities. Elul is a month in which HaShem relates to us in a reciprocal manner.

Avodah of the month of ‘Elul’ which is as the acronym [of the word] suggests with the words “

אני לדודי, ודודי לי

I am to my beloved, and my

The month of Elul: The Shabbos when this Maamor was said in 5748 was the first day of Rosh Chodesh Elul. Acronym: This is one of several Pessukim which are acronyms and

represent various different special services in Elul; five of them are: Torah- Torah study:
(Shmos 21:13) “ .

אָנה לַיְדוּ וְשִׁמְתִּי לָךְ

If he did not do it by design, but it came about by an act of G-d, I will assign you a place to which he can flee”.

Tefilah prayer: (Song of Songs 6:3)

נִי לְדוֹדִי “ וְדוֹדִי לִי

I am to my beloved and my beloved is to me; He browses among the lilies”.

Tzedokkah charity: (Megilas Esther 9:22) .

אִישׁ “ לַיַּעֲהוּ וּמִתְנוֹתָ לְאַבְיּוֹנִים

:The same days on which the Jews enjoyed relief from their foes and the same month which had been transformed for them from one of grief and mourning to one of festive joy.

They were to observe them as days of feasting and merry-making, and as an occasion for sending gifts to one another and presents to the poor”. Teshuvah – repentance: (Devorim 30:4) .

אֶת־לִבְּךָ וְאֶת־לִבְּב

“Then HaShem your G-d will open up your heart and the hearts of your

offspring to love HaShem your G-d with all your heart and soul, in order that you may live”.
Geulah redemption: (Shmos 15:1)

לְהִי “וַיֹּאמְרוּ לֹא מֵרָא שִׁירָה

Then Moshe and the B’nei Yisroel sang this song to HaShem.

They said: I will sing to HaShem, for He has triumphed gloriously; Horse and driver He has hurled into the sea”.

נִי לְדוֹן דִּי סֵט

• **: Shir Hashirim (6:3)**

אֲנִי לְדוֹן דִּי יוֹדוֹ דִּי לִי הָרָעָה בְּשׁוֹן שָׂנִים

•

“I am to my beloved, and my beloved is to me, who grazes among the roses.” I: The Jews as a nation and our spiritual counterpart up above. אֶל To my beloved: I am to HaShem. This has various connotations in Chassidus and Kabbalah, the first being as in the relationship between a groom and his bride where there is loyalty and exclusivity to each other. It is a time when HaShem’s “Thirteen Attributes of Mercy” illuminate His relationship with us. The Alter Rebbe explains with a metaphor: Anyone normally wishing to approach the King must go through the appropriate channels in the palace bureaucracy and gain the 18 | Page

beloved אֶל is to me.” אֶל Seemingly we need to understand; אֶל on the one hand our sages of blessed memory have stated; “HaShem does not demand more than one’s ability” and elsewhere it is explained that any Avodah that a person performs down here in this world below (Isarussa approval of a succession of secretaries and ministers. He must journey to the capital and pass through the many gates, corridors and antechambers that lead to the throne room. His presentation must be meticulously prepared, and he must adhere to an exacting code of dress, speech and mannerism upon entering into the royal presence. However, in the month of Elul the King comes out to the fields outside the city. At such times, anyone can approach him; the King receives them all with a smiling face and a radiant countenance. The peasant behind his plow has access to the King in a manner unavailable to the highest-ranking minister in the royal court when the King is in the palace. devotion, I am devoted to my beloved and my beloved is devoted to me, but it also about possession meaning I belong to my Beloved and my beloved belongs to me. Also, I come to you my beloved I beseech and request forgiveness, and Hashem asks us to forgive Him. Or I forgive You my beloved and I ask You my beloved to forgive me. אֶל Beloved: HaShem. אֶל To me: HaShem is specifically close to me and is mine after I am His first. אֶל We need to understand: What is the ethos of this Avodah in which a person first needs to self-inspire to self-motivate and come close to Hashem. 19 | Page

Dil'Tatoh)העneeds to be pre-empted by an impetus from above (Isarussa Dil'Eilah)עז. So how can we [possibly] say that the system of Avodah in Chodesh Elul relies on a person making the first move? נעAs the chosen Possuk illustrates that the Avodah of ' ,

אני לדודי

I am to my beloved'

(Issarusa Dil'Tatoh)עזis due first, and only afterwards comes the העIsarussa Dil'Tato: An inspiration from below. A self-motivated inspiration where a person inspires himself to become closer to Hashem and motivates himself to do more for his Yiddishkeit and his connection with Hashem. As a result of one's effort in his 'Isarussa Dil'Tatoh' he will be rewarded with an 'Isarussa Dil'Eilah. עזPre-empted: Because a person on his own could never inspire himself to come closer to HaShem without it. עזIsarussa Dil'Eilah: An arousal from above. A Divine inspiration from above. Where Hashem so to speak shines his countenance down upon the person drawing him in closer to Hashem. The general system is that when a person puts in the effort Hashem reciprocates by helping him along as the Talmud says (Yoma 38b): "If one comes to purify, they assist him". נעFirst Move: The first rung on the "HaShem – people" ladder is a person's unique service of an arousal from below, a person putting in the effort and hard work in his divine relationship. This service of a person 'first' is specifically important and easier to achieve in Elul. עזIssarusa Dil'Tatoh: Lit. an awakening from below. In our case, a person takes the first step to the plate and initiates a two-way relationship with HaShem. On the flip side there is also a concept of an arousal or an "awaKing from on high" which is potent in Tishrei during the High Holidays. The basic 20 | P a g e

Avodah of 'ל'י ד'ל' my beloved is to me' (Issarusa Dil'Eilah(?)And not the opposite as it is in a different Possuk, first ל'י ד'ל'and only thereafter)

פאן אן ל'ו

Yet according to what we have established above פפwe

process is as follows: first comes a slight nudge from HaShem, encouraging and giving us the power to achieve greatness; this is an Issarusa Dil'Eilah-an arousal from HaShem. Then comes our hard work and service as a response to HaShem's awakening from above, this is when we harness the power given to us for free without any hard work and put it into action with our Issarusa Dil'Tatoh. Finally, as a result of our hard work, showing HaShem we take his encouragement seriously by putting our gifted power into practice, and so long as everything else is in order with our spiritual quest there comes a reward from HaShem as a recognition of our hard work and a precursor for the next set of hard work; this final spiritual encounter is also an Issarusa Dil'Eilah, but a far superior Divine connection that cannot be elicited. Issarusa Dil'Eilah: An awakening from above. See above footnote for how this works. ני אפא: There is another Possuk in Shir Hashirim that reads

My beloved is to me, and then I am to him", hinting to an opposite chain of events, first HaShem's move, then ours.

The question is: If our hard work is only as a result of a preceding arousal from above, then why is the Avodah in Elul like the acronym, "I am to my Beloved and my Beloved is to me", implying we have to act first, if in truth we could turn the tables and say "My beloved is to me and only then am I to Him", referring to the seeming natural order of things: First HaShem, and then me. Above: Above we have explained that there is no contradiction in saying Moshe drew down our ability to "hear G-dliness" and he also drew down our ability to "see G-dliness". For, normally, the Divine extension is bound by the evolution of spirituality (Seder Hishtalshlus) and therefore limited to only "hearing", however in our special case, there was also a Divine extension from a source above 'Seder Hishtalshlus', allowing "sight" also to be drawn down. 21 | Page

that when we say in Chodesh Elul that the Avodah relies on a person's input first with an Issarusa Dil'Tatoh and only afterwards is one reciprocated with an Issarusa Dil'Eilah, that is [only] when one is referring to the system as it is within the confinement and parameters of the 'Seder Hishtalshelus'. (It is because of these limitations that the B'nei Yisroel are only extended a state of 'vision' as mentioned above). However, when operating from the perspective of 'beyond the confines and parameters' of the 'Seder Hishtalshelus', then, on the contrary, the impetus for We can say: Also, with the concept of "I am to my beloved and my beloved is to me". Issarusa Dil'Tatoh: From below, from a person's perspective, that a person's Avodah comes first. Issarusa Dil'Eilah: From above, HaShem's inspiration that comes afterwards. Seder Hishtalshelus: This is when the Divine extension is limited to the confines and rules of the set-up of the regular chain-reaction in the evolution of spirituality. Operating: When the revelation is running above the structure of, and there beyond Seder Hishtalshelus... On the contrary: Not only, in such a case, do we have a power and potential given from HaShem enabling us to achieve an Issarusa 22 | Page

the Avodah of ..

comes from the lofty Divine level of כִּי מִן שָׁמַיָּא which transcends the state of דוֹדִי.

And this 'Koach' is given [specifically] in the month of Elul and given generously. It is only as result of this 'Ko'ach' that one can thereafter draw down an Issarusa Dil'Eilah that was

triggered by one's own Issarusa Dil'Tatoh which is the reciprocation of ד'ל' ד'ל'. Furthermore, one is then even extended a Hamshocha as an Issarusa Dil'Eilah which surpasses the sort of Issarusa Dil'Eilah that one normally receives that is Dil'Tatoh, but even more than this..., Comes from: From an infinitely removed and exalted source, higher than any restrictions! Koach: This potential this impetus to achieve the ultimate in service of Hashem, that being "I am to my beloved", where we start off the intimacy. Thereafter: Only after there already is an arousal in a way that the awakening comes from us first, then can we..., Hamshocha: Not only is a spiritual arousal from above, gifted to us, extended as a result of our hard work, where its quality varies depending on the value of the arousal from below. but also, a unique, direct, aftermath arousal is extended 23 | Page

triggered by his Issarusa Dil'Tatoh. It is about this that the Zohar says that Hakodosh Boruch Hu will only dwell in a place which is complete. In other words this Divine inspiration cannot be drawn or triggered by a person's efforts, only when there is perfection in a person's efforts and in the Hamshocha Surpasses... Issarusa Dil'Tatoh: The level of this subsequent arousal is on such a heightened and removed level, that it isn't even in the capability of a person's hard work, to draw down and awaken such a spiritual energy. This: This extremely exalted arousal from above will only ever descend upon one who is completely fitting for this Divine arousal, so although it is not triggered by a person's actions it is however dependant on his environment. Complete: HaShem only dwells in a wholesome place, a place exalted via one's own hard work. Meaning, HaShem rewards one who is deserving by dwelling down below. The word 'Shelim' which we have translated as 'complete' also translates as 'peace' and as 'perfection' which means in order for one to merit this exalted Divine inspiration his surroundings must be perfect in his service of Hashem in his performance of positive Mitzvos and his abstaining from anything untoward, from his surroundings being perfectly peaceful harmonious and pure. By a person's efforts: Because in a regular way, a person's activities aren't naturally "complete". And this divine inspiration comes from a place that is so spiritually lofty that nothing a person can do can dent anything there. 24 | Page

that is given to him as a result, with which one makes the 'place complete' and then (without a prompt) a Hamshocha is extended which is higher than both of them. As a result: As a result of one's fulfilment and completion of service, is one able to draw down such a revelation, and when one utilises that Hamshocha to further his connection to Hashem through a greater commitment in his Avodah. Higher than both of them: As is explained in Likkutei Torah, that there is an advantage to the arousal from above which is drawn down by an arousal from below, and there is an advantage in an arousal from above which is extended down from itself, and not triggered from below. But then there is a third level which is greater than both the arousal triggered from below and the arousal straight from above and that is: "An arousal from above which is far superior to any arousal from below, such that an arousal from below cannot even reach at all... but nevertheless, it only ever shines and dwells when there is perfection in one's Avodah below post a divine arousal from above which was triggered by his self-inspired efforts, only then will this lofty superior arousal from above that

is completely out of reach of his efforts descend, shine and dwell in a revealed sense below. As has been explained elsewhere in connection with what the Medrash says on the Possuk in Shir Hashirim (2:5) „

אֲנִי שָׁנָה וְלִבִּי עֹרֵךְ קוֹל דּוֹדִי דּוֹפֵק פֶּתַחַי לִי

I sleep, but my heart is awake.

Hark! My beloved is knockKing: Open for me” and the Medrash says that Hashem says open for me the size of the eye of a needle and in return I will open for you the opening of a wedding hall. May we all truly merit to fully internalise all the subjects discussed at hand, bring them down into action and succeed in the ultimate Hamshocha, the revelation we are all waiting for, that of the coming Moshiach speedily in our days! <https://dvarmalchus.org/Download/AC129FE-BAF-4FB-BA-C2714E7849DA.pdf> Translated by Mendy Levy, authored by Menachem Mendel Levy, typeset by Mendel Levy, published by Menachem Levy, funded by Menachem Mendy Levy Thank you for proofreading Rabbi Sholom Osdoba - Mr. Jeremy Travers – Reb Avrohom de Keyser & Mr. Max Witriol. Special thanks to Koby Berkovitz for your incredible help with the footnotes. +447980956833 - hafotzashamaayonus@gmail.com